

The Prompt Ladder — Iterative Prompt Engineering

Samar Jamal | Track: General AI Fluency (Week 2) | Task: MediScan AI Case Study Prompting

Prompt Ladder Iterations Summary (6 Runs)

Run 0: Weak Baseline (Layer: *None*)

Output Change: Generic AI marketing fluff; zero tech specs or structure.

Run 1: Added Context (Layer: *Additional Context*)

Output Change: Output gained real tech names (Pinecone, Gemini) & parameters (0.72 threshold).

Run 2: Added Format (Layer: *Output Format*)

Output Change: Output gained clear Markdown visual hierarchy (Problem, Action, Outcome).

Run 3: Added Audience (Layer: *Defined Audience*)

Output Change: Tone shifted from amateur project to ML Engineering Lead terminology.

Run 4: Added Constraints (Layer: *Constraints (No Buzzwords)*)

Output Change: Minimal Improvement Moment: Run 3 had already removed fluff; minimal change.

Run 5: Added Verification (Layer: *Quality Criteria*)

Output Change: Output gained high-impact Before/After text comparison for recruiters.

Final Reusable Promot Template

Role: Expert technical portfolio coach. Generate engineering case study for [Project Name]. Audience: Senior ML Leads who value architecture trade-offs over marketing fluff. Parameters: Stack: [Tech Stack] | Problem: [Problem] | Decisions: [Key Decisions] | Metrics: [Outcomes] Format: 5 Markdown sections (Title, Problem, What I Did, Outcome, Before/After Comparison). Constraints: Strictly no buzzwords (revolutionary, cutting-edge). Direct technical past-tense.